

EDUCATION

2026.09 – PRESENT	STANFORD SCHOOL OF MEDICINE Masters in Translations Research and Applied Medicine (M-TRAM) candidate (expected graduation Junew, 2027)
2023.07 – PRESENT	STRITCH SCHOOL OF MEDICINE, LOYOLA UNIVERSITY CHICAGO MD Candidate (expected graduation May, 2028) MD Honors in Research Candidate
2017.09 – 2021.03	UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, SAN DIEGO [CUM LAUDE] Biochemistry and Cell Biology B.S. Business Minor focused in Entrepreneurship and Innovation - UCSD Rady School of Management

GRANTS, HONORS, AND AWARDS

2026	Loyola Endowed Scholarship Recipient
2025	Loyola Endowed Scholarship Recipient
2024	Zale Academic Scholarship Award in Ophthalmology
2024	Loyola Endowed Scholarship Recipient
2024	Illinois Society for the Prevention of Blindness (ISPB) Research Grant
2024	Dean’s Scholarship Awardee, STAR Summer Research Honors Program

RESEARCH

2023.10 – PRESENT	Stritch School of Medicine Department of Ophthalmology – Maywood, IL - Spearheading a prospective study examining biomarkers for diabetic retinopathy under the mentorship of Dr. Omer Iqbal M.D., and Dr. Felipe De Alba M.D. - Involved in IRB process, grant writing, and assay development. - Engaged in studies on eye microbiome and sleep apnea.
2019.07 – PRESENT	Center For Emerging and Neglected Diseases – UC Berkeley, CA - Researching the access and distribution of life-saving COVID-19 therapeutics. - Developed and assisted in running a small-molecule high throughput screening lab.
2020.06 – 2020.09	Bristol Myers Squibb – Lawrenceville, NJ Translational Medicine Intern - Oncology biomarker research on clinical trial patient samples. - Collaborated with a computer science intern to employ machine learning algorithms to optimize and comprehend biomarker discovery results.
2018.12 – 2019.06	Scripps Institute of Oceanography – La Jolla, CA Dr. Bill Fenical Lab Research Intern - Researched and worked on isolating and purifying nature-derived bioactive compounds. - Experience working with HPLC and LCMS to isolate and identify drug candidate molecules.

PUBLICATIONS AND PRESENTATIONS

<i>Poster Presentations:</i>	
2026.05	Stroumza J , Lee J, Sooranahalli C, Gomez K, DeAlba F, Iqbal O. <i>Trends in circulating levels of High-Mobility Group Box-1 in diabetic retinopathy</i> . Association for Research in Vision and Ophthalmology (ARVO) 2026 Annual Meeting; 2026 May 3; Denver, CO.
2025.11	Stroumza J , Lee J, Sooranahalli C, Gomez K, DeAlba F, Iqbal O. <i>Exploratory analysis of plasma 3-nitrotyrosine levels in patients with diabetic retinopathy</i> . St. Albert's Day; 2025 November 6; Maywood, IL.
2025.06	Stroumza J , Lee J, Sooranahalli C, DeAlba F, Iqbal O. <i>EG-VEGF levels in patients with diabetes with and without retinopathy</i> . American Diabetes Association (ADA) 85th Scientific Sessions; 2025 June 21; Chicago, IL.
2024.11	Stroumza J , Lee J, Sooranahalli C, DeAlba F, Iqbal O. <i>Blood Biomarkers in Diabetic Retinopathy</i> . St. Albert's Day; 2024 November 07; Maywood, IL.

2024.11	Tan S, Kumar R, Stroumza J , DeAlba F, Iqbal O. <i>The potential roles of Caspase-1/IL-8 signaling, HIF-1a, and VEGF in miRNA profile of retinal pigment epithelial cells and blood samples of patients with Obstructive Sleep Apnea for implications in the pathogenesis of Diabetic Retinopathy</i> . St. Albert's Day; 2024 November 07; Maywood, IL.
2024.11	Ramini A, Koul R, Stroumza J , Baharozian C, Tahar M, Vierling S, Gaynes B. <i>Intravitreal Biologics and Posterior Vitreous Detachment</i> . St. Albert's Day; 2024 November 07; Maywood, IL.
2023.10	Jones J, Huggins E, Dhablania N, Corbin W, Arolli X, Stroumza J , Abulencia P, El-Khateeb H, El-Khateeb I, Sharif E, Shaher D, Jatavallabhila K, Alcazar A, Tan S, Iqbal O, Dugas LR, Bouchard CS. <i>Ocular Manifestations of COVID-19: A Scoping Review</i> . St. Albert's Day; 2023 October 26; Maywood, IL.

Oral Presentations:

2024.09	Stroumza J , Ferris A, Pham M, Starnes T, Zilliox M, Bouchard C. <i>Ocular Rosacea and SJS: Microbial findings on the Ocular Surface</i> . Illinois Eye Symposium on Inflammation and Infection (IESII); 2024 September 28; Chicago, IL.
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Peer Reviewed Articles:

SUBMITTED	<i>Integration of Biomarkers in Common Retinal Neurodegenerative Diseases - A Comprehensive Review</i>
IN PREPARATION	<i>Identifying trends in serum and plasma biomarker levels in patients with different severities of diabetic retinopathy.</i>
IN PREPARATION	<i>Access to critical COVID-19 therapeutics during different phases of the pandemic with a focus on identifying geographic and racial disparities.</i>
2022.11	Nguyenla X, Wehri E, Van Dis E, Biering SB, Yamashiro LH, Zhu C, Stroumza J , Dugast-Darzacq C, Graham TGW, Wang X, Jockusch S, Tao C, Chien M, Xie W, Patel DJ, Meyer C, Garzia A, Tuschl T, Russo JJ, Ju J, Nääar AM, Stanley S, Schaletzky J. <i>Discovery of SARS-CoV-2 antiviral synergy between remdesivir and approved drugs in human lung cells</i> . Sci Rep. 2022 Nov. PMID: 36323770.
2021.06	Biering SB, Van Dis E, Wehri E, Yamashiro LH, Nguyenla X, Dugast-Darzacq C, Graham TGW, Stroumza JR , Golovkine GR, Roberts AW, Fines DM, Spradlin JN, Ward CC, Bajaj T, Dovala D, Schulze-Gamen U, Bajaj R, Fox DM, Ott M, Murthy N, Nomura DK, Schaletzky J, Stanley SA. <i>Screening a Library of FDA-Approved and Bioactive Compounds for Antiviral Activity against SARS-CoV-2</i> . ACS Infect Dis. 2021 Aug 13. PMID: 34129317.

LEADERSHIP

2023.07 – PRESENT	Stritch School of Medicine – Maywood, IL ■ Co-founder and President of Stritch Tri-Sports Organization ■ Leadership in Medicine Elective ■ Peer medical student tutor for M1 and M2 students ■ SIS Leader: Preparing M2 students for Step 1
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INSTITUTIONAL SERVICE

2023.07 – PRESENT	Volunteering – Chicago and Maywood, IL ■ Executive board and volunteer for Access To Care (ATC) Health Coach Program ■ Blue Line Ophthalmology Street Medicine Volunteer ■ YMCA Neighborhood Health Initiative Volunteer
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ACTIVITIES

2023.07 – PRESENT	Stritch School of Medicine Organizations and Electives – Maywood, IL ■ Founder and President of Stritch Tri-Sports Group/Organization at SSOM ■ Pickleball club member ■ Leadership in Medicine elective, The Inner Physician elective, Medical Spanish elective
2024.01 – 2024.07	Oak Park Concert Chorale – Oak Park, IL Bass Singer ■ Choral ensemble featuring both a cappella and accompanied works. ■ Formerly performed as a member of the San Francisco Boys Chorus, La Jolla Symphony Chorus, and UC San Diego Concert Choir.

CERTIFICATES AND SKILLS

- AO Principles of Clinical Research Course (2 Day Workshop) August 2024
 - Clinical study design and methodology
- Coding and Data management:
 - R, Python, SQL, RedCap
 - Using data warehouses such Palantir and Snowflake (large-scale data analysis)
 - Audited class BMB490: Machine Learning and AI for Molecular Biologists
- Clinical/Translational Research and Laboratory Experience
 - CITI Training for Prospective and Retrospective studies
 - Experience working with automated liquid-handling robots (CyBio, Tecan, etc.)
 - ELISA assays, Mass spectrometry, LCMS, Biochemical separation techniques

INTERESTS + HOBBIES

- Cycling, cooking, discovering hidden-gem restaurants, photography, hiking, sailing, visiting museums, and listening to choral pieces, orchestral works, alternative music, and EDM.